Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/vincent-synan (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Leadership
Financial Reporting
Product Management

Certifications

MBA Essentials
ICAgile Certified Professional - Agile Coaching
Certified Scrum Master
SAFe Practioner
PSK I - Professional Scrum with Kanban

Vincent Synan

Senior Delivery Lead at the Economist
Greater Guildford Area, United Kingdom

Summary

Experienced Agile Delivery Manager and Product Owner with a demonstrated history of working in the legal services and commercial industries. Skilled in Negotiation, Management, Agile, and Business Development. Strong media and communication professional with a Combined Arts focused in English literature and Politics from University of Leicester.

Experience

The Economist

Senior Delivery Manager
February 2023 - Present (3 years 5 months)
London, England, United Kingdom

Which?

3 years 11 months

Lead Delivery Manager
October 2021 - February 2023 (1 year 5 months)
London, England, United Kingdom

- Developing Agile best practices coaching framework for Delivery Leads to adopt and adapt.
- Created the Business Case and achieved the subsequent upgrade of Jira Premium and Nave (Kanban plug-in) to optimize digital delivery of Scrum and Kanban teams.
- Implemented ‘back-to-office’ hybrid working model, balancing squad safety with optimum organizational value.
- Managing, coaching and mentoring Delivery Leads – investing in them to assist in their career development.
- Created 8 hour Agile Coaching course ‘Agile Fundamentals’ for beginners and non-technical Agile enthusiasts.
- Hosted “The Forum” – the organization-wide quarterly Comms event. Interviewed the CEO and chaired the live Q&A session via Slido.

▪ Designed and Implemented the Quarterly Squads Delivery Plan – an integrated 3-monthly roadmap in Miro and Jira. Offers stakeholders at-a-glance, real-time updates of Epic completion, status, ETAs and blockers.

Senior Digital Delivery Manager
April 2020 - October 2021 (1 year 7 months)
London, England, United Kingdom

▪ Facilitated delivery of 2 squads as part of the new squads framework, incorporating various ‘Spotify model’ techniques.
▪ Delivered 2 squads – Mobile app (Kanban) and Content Experience (SCRUM).
o →Mobile app – delivered a new flagship Mobile application on React Native framework. Using in-house FTE talent, resulting in winding up of an efficient 3rd party provider and maximizing future potential .
o →Content Experience – migrated all Which? Content from multiple legacy systems to a single, headless CMS. Enabled integration with new Design System, increased engagement with Content authors and a more robust, flexible architecture.
▪ Coached a Junior Scrum Master. Secured funding for training courses, coached through regular 1:1s, formulated personal OKRs.
▪ Created the Which? Digital Monthly showcase – an opportunity for the Product and Tech teams to demo to a larger audience of non-technical peers. Audience engagement driven up to 100 by rotating demos, quizzes, prizes and awards.
▪ Created the Delivery Lead ‘Communities of Practice’ with DL Peers and guests. A forum to work through common issues and share new ideas from the world of Agile.
▪ Oversaw Web performance task force – responding to Google ‘Core Web vitals’ demands. Successfully improved performance of which? Homepage resulting in improved Google ranking and bounce rate reduction of 8%.
▪ Challenged engineers to ideate the best JIRA automations possible. Pick of the bunch has been automating all release management (Github > circle-ci > Jira) – resulting in ‘push button’ versioning and CAB documentation (ITIL). Outcome = ~30 engineering hours of manual processes saved per week.

Digital Delivery Manager
April 2019 - April 2020 (1 year 1 month)
London, United Kingdom

▪ Pioneered the adoption of Miro – a digital whiteboarding tool for Planning, retrospectives etc. When remote working became de facto, was able to share knowledge share my skills to all teams.

▪ Developed JIRA Release Management framework and process (including best practices documentation) for a cross-project CRM programme. Using JIRA Releases, agreed versioning model, environment dashboard etc.
▪ Successfully delivered MVP to migrate Which? Legal Service onto Salesforce CRM stack in May 2020. Outcome has enabled improved management of contact information – with core services migrating in 2021.
▪ Introduced PI Planning and PI Programme boards (SAFe concepts) to Which? Development community. Facilitated onsite PI Planning day with 60+ participants producing CRM Roadmap for Q1 of 2020.
▪ Post-lockdown, successfully ran PI Planning day remotely using Miro board and breakout Google hangouts.
▪ Introduced key agile Ways of Working and Scrum techniques to a CRM Programme that was failing to deliver due to lack of focus and direction.
▪ Facilitated Product Development teams delivering value features for Which? Money and Which? Reviews products.
▪ Ensured Scrum values adhered to – and facilitated all required ceremonies (standups, Planning, Refinement and Demo/Retro) and produced all required reporting for Senior Management.

Worth Internet Systems
Scrum Master
February 2019 - April 2019 (3 months)
Reading, Berkshire, United Kingdom

▪ Delivered MVP for Innovation Funding Service – a government portal that promotes UK Innovation through means tested grants and loans
▪ Ensured aggressive deadline of 3 months met (due to Brexit deadline). The completed delivery was an extension to the website to allow UK government to underwrite funding for EU Horizon 2020 projects.
▪ Changes released by the team enabled existing users to validated and reapplied through new fast track system.
▪ Delivered 2 Scrum teams – Horizon 2020 project team delivered IFS enhancements and BAU team maintained existing services.
▪ Fostered an agile culture across the department (a mixture of contract and FTEs) – introducing and enhancing Scrum events and developed Rewards + recognition scheme (‘Sprint hero’ and improved show and tells).

Seeking a new professional challenge
Project Manager Scrum Master
January 2019 - January 2019 (1 month)
Guildford, United Kingdom

LexisNexis UK

5 years 4 months

Product Owner

July 2018 - December 2018 (6 months)

London, United Kingdom

Product Owner + Agile Delivery Manager duties.

RESPONSIBILITIES AND ACHIEVEMENTS

▪ Created a new Agile squad, mixture of LexisNexis permanent developers and contractors. Organized necessary digital and physical boards for team to begin working on assignments.

▪ Engaged team members via a team kickoff and facilitated decisions about Agile methodologies (e.g. Kanban chosen over Scrum, event timings).

PROJECT: WWW.LEXISSMARTFORMS.CO.UK

▪ Facilitated 2 day onsite ‘event storming’ session for requirements gathering.

▪ Produced a key business artefact – a ‘post-it user journey map’ which highlighted all system and product pain points.

▪ Used Kibana™ to gather Web Analytics to further validate and prioritize stories.

▪ Contributed to a Lean Canvas to secure funding for the development (identifying risks/benefits).

▪ Led a 6-week project on time and to budget for LexisNexis Smart Forms and its backend system. Outcomes realised:

o Reduced time to market from 24-36 hours to 1-3 hours

o Created Splunk™ dashboard to give users visibility of data journey and duration ‘from agency to screen’

▪ Identified and engaged director level stakeholders regarding the portfolio via weekly reports.

▪ Migrated Editorial system from physical server to cloud host (AWS) within 8 weeks. Cost savings +50% and a reduction of release cycle duration from 7 to 2 days.

Scrum Master

September 2017 - June 2018 (10 months)

RESPONSIBILITIES AND ACHIEVEMENTS

▪ Delivered Hong Kong Practical Guidance Product (LexisPSL™) for Asia Pacific markets (APAC).

▪ Led Asia Pacific VersionOne team and facilitated Scrum events between UK and India Dev and APAC Product teams.

▪ Delivered 2.5 million UK legal documents to APAC for LexisAdvance™ within 9-month deadline. Outcomes achieved:
o Content Pipeline system configured – using Python and xml technologies.
o Operational Readiness completed – with SLAs agreed for time to market and error handling.
o Migrated UK content onto APAC product (estimated $5m revenue).
▪ Coached UK and AU/NZ developers in Agile and Scrum best practice. Became a VersionOne™ champion.

Scrum Master
February 2015 - September 2017 (2 years 8 months)
Woking, UK

RESPONSIBILITIES AND ACHIEVEMENTS
▪ Created and onboarded 3 new Scrum teams onto the SAFe™ framework – then moved to a weekly Kanban approach to fit with 2017 migration plan.
▪ Managed all Scrum and Kanban events for the Law team (Refinement, Planning, Retrospectives, Daily Stand-ups and Deep Dives.). Resolved blockers, escalated larger issues where necessary.
▪ Ensured all dependencies with other Scrum teams were identified and scheduled.
▪ Estimated and committed to a realistic number of business features based on team capacity using story points.
▪ Collaborated with Product Owners, honing user stories and functional requirements for new and improved features.
▪ Completed the delivery of 600+ content sources (containing 4 million xml documents) required for MVP revamp of UK product (£120m revenue).
▪ Persuaded US business partners to move from full data delivery (Waterfall approach) to MVP (Agile). This resulted in faster DEV/CERT testing success and increased velocity.
▪ Reduced unnecessary handovers within data delivery process. Championed end-to-end delivery to reduce waste.
▪ Produced real-time dashboards using VSTS and Excel to generate on demand reporting for senior stakeholders.

NewLexis Fabrication Manager
September 2013 - February 2015 (1 year 6 months)
Woking, UK

Managed 3 teams responsible for data conversion on NewLexis project
Oversaw expansion of resource from 8 to 24 heads. Using Change Management, transformed the team from 100% onsite permanent staff to

a mixture of onshore and offshore, permanent and contractors. This led to upskilling of the team as well as cost-savings.
Led recruitment and training of new staff in Woking and Pune (India). This involved interviewing onshore and offshore, as well as the creation of an XSLT exam to assess technical skills. Had to negotiate with recruitment agents to ensure budget was adhered to.

LexisNexis
LexisLibrary Fabrication Manager
September 2006 - September 2013 (7 years 1 month)
woking, UK

▪ Delivered expansion of team from 8 to 24 people. Transformed from 100% onsite permanent staff to a mixture of onshore and offshore, permanent and contractors. This led to upskilling of the team as well as required cost-savings.
▪ Created XSLT and Python coding exams to assess technical skills of potential recruitment candidates. Negotiated regularly with recruitment agents to ensure budget was adhered to.
▪ Line managed 8 full-time developers, including annual appraisals, arranging necessary training and 1-2-1s.
▪ Led Digital transformation by introducing new Agile Practices into the team used to Waterfall methodologies.

I received a 2013 LexisNexis high achiever award for the overall concept, delivery and project management of a Content conversion system - the FTK. I created presentation of the core principles of the FTK, to demonstrate to prospective adopters in Austria and Hong Kong. It can be viewed here: http://prezi.com/xzaewxevmpmq/ftk-and-how-it-works/

Education

University of Leicester
Combined Arts, English literature and Politics · (1997 - 2000)